4
BLOCKS

Study Guide: Verb Tenses

To be · There is/are · Present and Past Simple · Present and Past Continuous. Four one-hour study blocks to do on your own.

i HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Welcome! You can do this

While your teacher is away, you will complete **4 study blocks**. Each block is equal to **one class of 60 minutes**. Do one block, rest, and then continue another day. Small steps every few days work better than one long session.

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	TIME
1 Theory	Read the explanation. Say the examples **out loud**.	20 min
2 Reading	Read a short text, then answer the questions.	10 min
3 Listening	Listen (or read aloud), then answer the questions.	10 min
4 Practice	Do 4 or 5 exercises. Do **not** look at the answers.	20 min

BLOCK	TOPIC	SUGGESTED DAY (IN 15 DAYS)
1	To be + There is / There are	Days 2–3
2	Present Simple + Past Simple	Days 5–6
3	Present Continuous + Past Continuous	Days 9–10
4	Putting it all together (review of all tenses)	Days 13–14

Rules of the game

1. Write **your own** answers in every box. Your work is saved on this device.
2. Check the **Answer Key** at the very end of the guide **only after** you finish a block.
3. Correct your mistakes with a different color or in the box, and try to understand **why** you were wrong.
4. When you finish, press **Copy my answers** at the end and send them to your teacher.

No audio? For every listening activity you can **read the script aloud** (after trying to listen), or paste it into a **text-to-speech** tool: the "Read aloud" feature of your browser, the speaker button in Google Translate, or the "Speak" function on your phone. Choose an American English voice (English, US).

1 BLOCK 1 about 60 min

To Be + There is / There are

Describe people, places and things: who you are, where things are and what exists.

1 Theory

1. The verb *to be*

	PRESENT	PAST
+	I **am** (I'm) · you **are** (you're) · he/she/it **is** (he's) · we/you/they **are**	I/he/she/it **was** · you/we/they **were**
–	I'm **not** · you **aren't** · he/she/it **isn't** · we/you/they **aren't**	I/he/she/it **wasn't** · you/we/they **weren't**
?	**Am** I...? **Are** you...? **Is** he/she/it...?	**Was** I/he/she/it...? **Were** you/we/they...?

Short answers: Are you tired? → *Yes, I **am**. / No, I'm not.* (We never say "Yes, I'm".)

When do we use *to be*?

- **Identity, job, nationality:** "I'm a nurse." "She's Brazilian."
- **Age:** "He is thirty (years old)." (English uses *be*, not *have*.)
- **Feelings and states:** "We're tired." "I was nervous yesterday."
- **Description:** "The apartment is bright and the kitchen is small."
- **Location:** "The keys are on the table." "Where were you last night?"
- **Time and weather:** "It's 8 o'clock." "It was cold on Monday."

2. There is / There are

We use **there is / there are** to say that something **exists** or **is in a place**. We often use it to introduce something **new**.

	PRESENT	PAST
+ singular / uncountable	**There is** (there's) a park. · **There is** some water.	**There was** a party.
+ plural	**There are** two bedrooms.	**There were** three people.
–	There **isn't** a movie theater. · There **aren't any** stores.	There **wasn't** an elevator. · There **weren't any** windows.
?	**Is there** a bank near here? · **Are there any** restaurants?	**Was there** a problem? · **Were there any** tickets?

Short answers: Is there an elevator? → *Yes, there **is**. / No, there **isn't**.* · Are there any stores? → *Yes, there **are**. / No, there **aren't**.*

Some / any / a lot of: *some* in positive sentences ("There are some books"), *any* in negatives and questions ("There aren't any books. Are there any books?"), *a lot of* for large quantities. **How many** (countable) / **how much** (uncountable): "How many bedrooms are there?" "How much milk is there?"

3. Contrast: *It is* vs *There is*

There is... introduces something new.
"**There is** a park near my house."

It is... describes something we already know.
"**It is** big and very green."

Dica Brasil: "Tem uma padaria aqui perto" is **There is a bakery near here** (not "Have a bakery"). We also say "My house **has** a garden" (possession) = "**There is** a garden at my house" (existence).

4. Common mistakes

✘ WRONG	✔ RIGHT
~~I have 25 years.~~	I'm 25 (years old).
~~Have a park near my house.~~	There is a park near my house.
~~There is three chairs.~~	There are three chairs.
~~Is a cat in the yard?~~	Is there a cat in the yard?
~~There are some milk.~~	There is some milk. (uncountable)
~~Are you tired? Yes, I'm.~~	Yes, I am.

2 Reading: Welcome to My Neighborhood

What to do

1. Read the text once without stopping. Tap the highlighted words to see how the grammar works.
2. Read it again, underline the verbs from this block, and listen to the audio (optional).
3. Answer the questions in full sentences.

🎧 **Listen to the text (optional)** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

My name is Marta, and I am a nurse. I'm 29 years old and I'm from Porto Alegre, but now I live in a small apartment in São Paulo. My neighborhood is quiet and friendly. There is a bakery on the corner, and there are two supermarkets near my building. There isn't a movie theater, but there is a big park with a lake. On Sundays, there are always many families there. Ten years ago, the neighborhood was very different. There weren't any cafés and the streets were dirty. Now there are lots of stores and the people are happier. My favorite place is the library. It's old, but it's beautiful, and the librarians are very kind. Are there places like this where you live?

R **Reading questions**

1 Where does Marta live now?

2 Is there a movie theater in her neighborhood?

3 What was different ten years ago?

4 What is Marta's favorite place and why?

3 Listening: Lisa's new apartment

Tom asks Lisa about her new home.

What to do

1. Read the questions first. Then press play and listen **without** reading the script.
2. Listen again and answer the questions.
3. Open the script and check. Then **read it aloud** to practice your pronunciation.

🎧 **Lisa's new apartment** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

No audio? Ask a friend to read the script aloud, read it aloud yourself, or paste it into a text-to-speech tool (see the start of this guide).

L Listening questions

1 How many bedrooms are there in Lisa's apartment?

2 Is there a dishwasher?

3 What is near Lisa's building?

4 What was there on the roof last week?

5 What was wrong with her old studio?

▼ **Show the script (after you listen)**

Tom: Hi Lisa! How's your new apartment?
Lisa: It's great! It's small, but it's very bright. There are two bedrooms and a balcony.
Tom: Is there a washing machine?
Lisa: Yes, there is, but there isn't a dishwasher.
Tom: Are there any stores nearby?
Lisa: Yes! There's a supermarket and there are three restaurants on my street.
Tom: And how are the neighbors?
Lisa: They're really nice. Last week there was a party on the roof, and everyone was friendly.
Tom: That sounds wonderful. Where were you before this apartment?
Lisa: I was in a tiny studio. There weren't any windows in the kitchen!

4 Practice

What to do

1. Do the exercises in order. Do not look at the answers.

2. Write something in every box, even if you are not sure.

3. When you finish, go to the Answer Key at the end and correct your work.

A Choose the correct option.

1	She _____ from Chile.	a am	b is	c are
2	There _____ two windows in the kitchen.	a is	b are	c have
3	_____ there a bank near here?	a Is	b Are	c Does
4	The keys _____ on the table yesterday.	a was	b were	c are
5	There _____ any milk in the fridge.	a isn't	b aren't	c hasn't
6	I _____ 30 years old.	a have	b am	c has

B Complete the sentences with *is*, *are*, *was*, *were* or a *there* form.

1 _____ a lot of traffic in my city every morning.

2 My parents _____ at home last night.

3 _____ twelve students in my class.

4 Ten years ago, _____ any cafés on this street.

5 _____ a bakery near your house?

6 The movie _____ very long, so I fell asleep.

C Find the mistake and write the correct sentence.

1. ~~I have 20 years old.~~
   Write the correct sentence

2. ~~Have a bakery near my house.~~
   Write the correct sentence

3. ~~There is three chairs in the room.~~
   Write the correct sentence

4. ~~Is a cat in the yard?~~
   Write the correct sentence

5. ~~Are you a student? Yes, I'm.~~
   Write the correct sentence

D Your turn: write 1 to 3 sentences for each.

1. Describe your neighborhood. What is there? What isn't there?

2. Where were you yesterday at 8 pm? How were you?

3. Describe your bedroom: say five things that there are in it.

4. How was your city ten years ago? Use there was / there were.

Finished? Tick the four boxes at the top of this block and check the Answer Key.

2 BLOCK 2 about 60 min

Present Simple + Past Simple

Talk about routines, facts and finished events: now, yesterday and in the past.

1 Theory

1. Present Simple

	FORM	EXAMPLE
+	I/you/we/they **work** · he/she/it **works**	She **works** in a hospital.
–	**don't** / **doesn't** + base verb	He **doesn't like** fish.
?	**Do** / **Does** + subject + base verb	**Does** she **work** here?

Spelling of he/she/it: work → work**s** · go → go**es** · watch → watch**es** · study → stud**ies** · play → play**s** (vowel + y).

Use it for…

- **Habits and routines:** "I take the bus every day."
- **Facts and permanent situations:** "Water boils at 100°C." "She lives in Recife."
- **Schedules:** "The train leaves at 7:15."
- **States** (know, like, want, need): "I know the answer."

Frequency adverbs: always, usually, often, sometimes, rarely, never. They go **before** the main verb and **after** *be*: "I **usually** walk" · "She is **always** late."

2. Past Simple

	FORM	EXAMPLE
+	verb + **-ed** (regular) or irregular form	I **worked** / I **went**.
–	**didn't** + base verb	I **didn't go**.
?	**Did** + subject + base verb	**Did** you **see** it?

Regular spelling: work → work**ed** · live → live**d** · study → stud**ied** · stop → stop**ped**. **Pronunciation of -ed:** /t/ in *worked*, /d/ in *played*, /ɪd/ in *wanted*.

COMMON IRREGULAR VERBS

be → was/were	go → went	have → had	do → did	see → saw	eat → ate
drink → drank	buy → bought	take → took	make → made	come → came	get → got
give → gave	write → wrote	say → said	meet → met	leave → left	find → found

Use it for…

- **Finished actions at a definite time:** "I saw that movie last night."
- **A sequence of events (a story):** "I woke up, had coffee and left."

- **Past habits or states that stopped:** "When I was a child, I played soccer every day."

Time expressions: yesterday, last night / week / year, two days **ago**, in 2019, when I was young.

3. Contrast: Present Simple vs Past Simple

Present (now, always)
I **work** in a bank.
She **doesn't eat** meat.
Do you **live** here?

Past (finished)
I **worked** in a bank for five years.
She **didn't eat** meat last night.
Did you **live** here in 2020?

Golden rule: after **do / does / did / don't / doesn't / didn't** the main verb is always in the **base form**: "Did she **go**?" (not "Did she went?").

4. Common mistakes

✘ WRONG	✔ RIGHT
~~She don't like coffee.~~	She doesn't like coffee.
~~Did you went to school?~~	Did you go to school?
~~I didn't saw the movie.~~	I didn't see the movie.
~~He go to work by bus.~~	He goes to work by bus.
~~Yesterday I am tired.~~	Yesterday I was tired.
~~She works yesterday.~~	She worked yesterday.

2 Reading: A Day in the Life: Then and Now

What to do

1. Read the text once without stopping. Tap the highlighted words to see how the grammar works.
2. Read it again, underline the verbs from this block, and listen to the audio (optional).

3. Answer the questions in full sentences.

🎧 **Listen to the text (optional)** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

Hi, I'm Leo and I work as a graphic designer. Every weekday I wake up at 6:30, have a quick breakfast and take the bus to the office. I usually start work at 8:00, and I never skip lunch. In the evening I go to the gym or I watch a series. On weekends I don't work, so I often see my friends. Last year my routine was very different. I worked from home and I didn't leave the house much. I woke up late, I ate in front of the computer and I felt tired all the time. Then, in March, I found a new job in a bigger company. My boss gave me an interesting project and I moved to an apartment near the office. It changed my life! I met new people, I learned new skills and I started to run in the park. Does my life sound busy? Maybe, but I love it.

R Reading questions

1 What time does Leo wake up on weekdays?

2 Does he work on weekends?

3 What was Leo's routine like last year?

4 Why did his life change?

3 Listening: My weekend

Rita talks about her weekends: what she usually does and what she did last Saturday.

What to do

1. Read the questions first. Then press play and listen **without** reading the script.
2. Listen again and answer the questions.

3. Open the script and check. Then **read it aloud** to practice your pronunciation.

🎧 **My weekend** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

No audio? Ask a friend to read the script aloud, read it aloud yourself, or paste it into a text-to-speech tool (see the start of this guide).

L Listening questions

1 True or false? Rita usually wakes up early on Saturdays.

2 True or false? Last Saturday she went to the coast by train.

3 True or false? She took her phone to the beach.

4 What did she eat in the evening?

5 Who does she visit on Sundays?

▼ Show the script (after you listen)

Hi everyone! I'm Rita and today I want to talk about my weekend. On Saturdays I usually wake up late and I don't cook breakfast. I go to the market and I buy fruit and bread. Last Saturday, however, I did something different. I woke up at six, I took the train to the coast and I spent the whole day on the beach. I didn't take my phone, so nobody called me! In the evening I met my cousins and we ate fish at a small restaurant. On Sundays I always visit my grandmother. She lives near the park and she makes great coffee. Yesterday she told me an old story about her childhood. I loved it.

4 Practice

What to do

1. Do the exercises in order. Do not look at the answers.
2. Write something in every box, even if you are not sure.
3. When you finish, go to the Answer Key at the end and correct your work.

A Choose the correct option.

1. She _____ coffee every morning. — a drink / b drinks / c drinking
2. He _____ to the gym yesterday. — a go / b goes / c went
3. _____ you like pizza? — a Do / b Does / c Did
4. I didn't _____ the movie. — a see / b saw / c seen
5. They _____ in London in 2019. — a live / b lived / c lives
6. What time _____ the train leave? (schedule) — a do / b does / c did

B Write the correct form of the verb in brackets, or the missing word.

1. She _____ (work) in a hospital. She loves it.
2. Yesterday we _____ (watch) a great movie.
3. He _____ (not / like) fish, so he never orders it.
4. _____ you go to the party last Saturday?
5. I _____ (buy) these shoes two weeks ago.
6. What time _____ the store open on Sundays?
7. They _____ (not / see) the news yesterday.
8. My sister _____ (study) English at night.

C Transform the sentences as shown.

1. ~~He plays soccer on Saturdays. (negative)~~
   Write the correct sentence

2. ~~She lives in Recife. (question)~~
   Write the correct sentence

3. ~~We visited our grandparents. (negative)~~
   Write the correct sentence

4. ~~They went to the movies. (question)~~
   Write the correct sentence

5. ~~I eat breakfast at seven. (past)~~
   Write the correct sentence

D Your turn: write 2 or 3 sentences for each.

1. Describe your daily routine on a weekday.

2. What did you do last weekend?

3. Tell me about your first job or your first day at school.

4. Name something you never do, and something you did for the first time last year.

Finished? Tick the four boxes at the top of this block and check the Answer Key.

3 BLOCK 3 about 60 min

Present Continuous + Past Continuous

Describe actions in progress: what is happening now and what was happening in the past.

1 Theory

1. Present Continuous

	FORM	EXAMPLE
+	am / is / are + verb-**ing**	She **is cooking** dinner.
–	am not / isn't / aren't + verb-ing	They **aren't working** today.
?	Am / Is / Are + subject + verb-ing?	**What are** you **doing**?

-ing spelling: work → work**ing** · make → mak**ing** · run → run**ning** · lie → l**ying** · study → study**ing**.

Use it for...

- **Actions happening now:** "Be quiet! The baby **is sleeping**."
- **Temporary situations (around now):** "This week I'**m working** from home."
- **Changing situations:** "Prices **are rising**."
- **Future arrangements:** "I'**m meeting** Julia at 7 tonight."
- **Annoying habits with *always*:** "He **is always losing** his keys!"

Time expressions: now, right now, at the moment, today, this week, currently.

Stative verbs (know, like, love, hate, want, need, believe, understand, prefer, have for possession) are **not** normally used in the continuous: "I **know** the answer" (not "I'm knowing"). But "I'm **having** lunch" is fine (action).

Present Simple vs Present Continuous

PRESENT SIMPLE	PRESENT CONTINUOUS
I drink coffee every morning. (habit)	I'**m drinking** coffee now. (action in progress)
She lives in Recife. (permanent)	She'**s living** with her sister this month. (temporary)

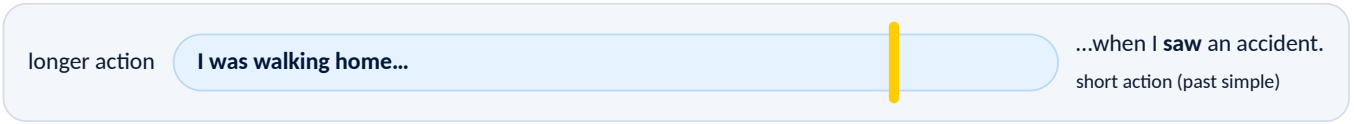
2. Past Continuous

	FORM	EXAMPLE
+	was / were + verb-ing	I **was cooking**.
–	wasn't / weren't + verb-ing	They **weren't listening**.
?	Was / Were + subject + verb-ing?	**Where were** you **going**?

Use it for…

- **An action in progress at a specific moment in the past:** "At 8 pm yesterday I **was cooking**."
- **The background of a story:** "It **was raining** and people **were running**."
- **A longer action interrupted by a shorter one:** "I **was walking** home when I **saw** an accident."
- **Two actions at the same time:** "While I **was cooking**, he **was watching** TV."

3. Contrast: Past Simple vs Past Continuous



Past Simple = a complete event.
"I **read** the book." (I finished it.)
"When I **arrived**, they **left**." (first I arrived, then they left)

Past Continuous = an action in progress.
"I **was reading** the book." (in the middle of it)
"When I **arrived**, they **were having** lunch." (they were already eating)

When / While: while + past continuous (a long action): "While I **was walking**…" · **when** + past simple (a short event): "…when it **started** to rain."

4. Common mistakes

✘ WRONG	✔ RIGHT
~~I was go to work.~~	I was going to work.
~~I'm knowing the answer.~~	I know the answer.
~~He is work now.~~	He is working now.
~~While I walked, I was seeing a fox.~~	While I was walking, I saw a fox.
~~When I was arriving, they ate.~~	When I arrived, they were eating.

2 Reading: A Strange Evening

What to do

1. Read the text once without stopping. Tap the highlighted words to see how the grammar works.
2. Read it again, underline the verbs from this block, and listen to the audio (optional).

3. Answer the questions in full sentences.

🎧 **Listen to the text (optional)** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

Last Friday I was walking home from work when it started to rain. I was carrying my laptop, but I didn't have an umbrella, so I was running to the bus stop. While I was waiting for the bus, I noticed an old man. He was sitting alone on a bench and he was holding a small cat. The cat was shaking because it was cold. I took off my jacket and put it over the cat. The man smiled and said, "Thank you. I'm waiting for my daughter. She's coming to pick us up." A few minutes later, a car stopped and a young woman got out. She was laughing and crying at the same time. "Dad! Why are you sitting here in the rain? We're looking for you everywhere!" When I finally got on the bus, I was wet, but I was happy.

R **Reading questions**

1 What was the writer doing when it started to rain?

2 What was the old man holding?

3 Why was the cat shaking?

4 Who was the old man waiting for?

3 Listening: What were you doing?

A police officer asks Mr. Lopes about last night.

What to do

1. Read the questions first. Then press play and listen **without** reading the script.
2. Listen again and answer the questions.

3. Open the script and check. Then **read it aloud** to practice your pronunciation.

🎧 **What were you doing?** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

No audio? Ask a friend to read the script aloud, read it aloud yourself, or paste it into a text-to-speech tool (see the start of this guide).

L Listening questions

1 Where was Mr. Lopes at nine o'clock?

2 What was he doing?

3 What was his sister doing?

4 What did they hear while they were eating?

5 What were the two men doing?

6 What is Mr. Lopes doing this week?

▼ **Show the script (after you listen)**

Officer: Good morning, Mr. Lopes. Where were you last night at nine o'clock?
Mr. Lopes: I was at home. I was cooking dinner.
Officer: Was anyone with you?

Mr. Lopes: Yes, my sister was watching TV in the living room while I was cooking.
Officer: Did you hear anything strange?
Mr. Lopes: Yes. While we were eating, we heard a loud noise outside. I looked out of the window and I saw two men. They were running down the street.
Officer: What were they carrying?
Mr. Lopes: I don't know. It was dark and it was raining.
Officer: Thank you. Are you working this week?
Mr. Lopes: Yes, I'm working from home, so I'm here all day.

4 Practice

What to do

1. Do the exercises in order. Do not look at the answers.
2. Write something in every box, even if you are not sure.
3. When you finish, go to the Answer Key at the end and correct your work.

A Choose the correct option.

1	Please be quiet! The baby _____.	a sleeps	b is sleeping	c sleeping
2	I _____ the answer, I'm sure.	a know	b am knowing	c was knowing
3	At 9 pm last night, I _____ a series.	a watched	b was watching	c am watching
4	She was cooking when the phone _____.	a rang	b was ringing	c rings
5	_____ you working this week?	a Do	b Are	c Did
6	While he was driving, his children _____ in the back.	a slept	b were sleeping	c sleeping

B **Write the correct form of the verb in brackets, or the missing word.**

1. Look! It _____ (snow).
2. I usually take the bus, but today I _____ (walk) to work.
3. At eight o'clock yesterday, we _____ (have) dinner.
4. He _____ (not / listen) when the teacher called his name.
5. What _____ you doing when I called?
6. My brother _____ (always / lose) his keys!
7. I _____ (wait) for the bus when I saw an old friend.
8. They _____ (not / work) today because it's a holiday.

C **Write *when* or *while*.**

1. I was reading _____ the lights went out.
2. _____ she was cooking, he was setting the table.
3. We were walking in the park _____ it started to rain.
4. He fell asleep _____ he was watching TV.
5. _____ I arrived, they were having lunch.

D **Your turn: write 1 or 2 sentences for each.**

1 What are you doing right now? And what are you doing this week that is different from usual?

2 What were you doing at 8 pm yesterday?

3 Tell about a time when something interrupted you (use when / while).

4 What is something that is changing in your city or your life?

Finished? Tick the four boxes at the top of this block and check the Answer Key.

4 BLOCK 4 about 60 min

Putting It All Together

Choose the right tense every time: review, contrast and free practice with everything you learned.

1 Theory

1. Which tense? A decision guide

ASK YOURSELF…	USE…	SIGNAL WORDS	EXAMPLE
Who/what is it? Where is it? How is it?	**To be**	age, job, place, feeling	She **is** a doctor. They **were** late.
Does it exist? Is it in a place?	**There is / are / was / were**	some, any, a lot of	**There are** three parks.
Is it a habit, a fact or a state?	**Present Simple**	every day, usually, never	I **work** in a bank.
Is it happening now, or around now?	**Present Continuous**	now, at the moment, this week	I'**m working** from home.
Did it finish in the past?	**Past Simple**	yesterday, last week, ago	I **worked** there in 2019.
Was it in progress at a past moment, or is it the background?	**Past Continuous**	at 8 pm, while, when	I **was working** when you called.

2. The same verb, six meanings

Present Simple
I **work** in a bank.
my job, in general

Present Continuous
I'**m working** now.
at this moment

Past Simple
I **worked** there for five years.
finished

Past Continuous
I **was working** when you called.
in progress, interrupted

To be
It **was** a long day. I'**m** tired.
states and descriptions

There is / was
There was a lot of work. **There is** a deadline.
what exists

3. Five-second checklist before you speak or write

1. Is the action **finished** or **in progress**? (simple or continuous)
2. Is it **now** or **past**? Look for time words.
3. Is it a **state** (know, like, want)? Then avoid the continuous.
4. After **do / does / did**, use the **base verb**.

5. Are you saying something **exists**? Use **there is / there are**, not "have".

Dica Brasil: in English the subject is always necessary ("It's raining", "There is a problem") and the verb must agree: *she goes*, *they were*, *there are*.

2 Reading: Greetings from Lisbon

What to do

1. Read the text once without stopping. Tap the highlighted words to see how the grammar works.
2. Read it again, underline the verbs from this block, and listen to the audio (optional).
3. Answer the questions in full sentences.

🎧 **Listen to the text (optional)** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

Hi Carla! Greetings from Lisbon! I'm writing this message from a small café near the river. It's sunny and there are a lot of tourists. Yesterday we visited the castle. We were taking photos when it started to rain, so we ran into a museum. There was an interesting exhibition about the history of the city. I usually don't like museums, but I really enjoyed this one. At the moment, my friends are shopping, but I'm drinking coffee and writing to you. Tomorrow we're taking a train to Porto. Do you want to come? Write soon! Marco.

R Reading questions

1 Where is Marco now?

2 What were they doing when it started to rain?

3 Does Marco usually like museums?

4 What are they doing tomorrow?

3 Listening: A voicemail from the airport

Pedro leaves a message for his friend Marta.

What to do

1. Read the questions first. Then press play and listen **without** reading the script.
2. Listen again and answer the questions.
3. Open the script and check. Then **read it aloud** to practice your pronunciation.

🎧 **A voicemail from the airport** (audio in the web version; or read the script aloud)

No audio? Ask a friend to read the script aloud, read it aloud yourself, or paste it into a text-to-speech tool (see the start of this guide).

L Listening questions

1 Where is Pedro now?

2 Why is he sitting in a café?

3 What was he doing when he realized he didn't have his passport?

4 Where did he find his passport?

5 Why is he tired this week?

6 What does he want Marta to do?

▼ **Show the script (after you listen)**

Hi Marta, it's Pedro. I'm calling from the airport. My flight is delayed, so I'm sitting in a café and drinking a very bad coffee. There are a lot of people here, and the line is huge! Yesterday I was packing my suitcase when I realized that I didn't have my passport. I looked everywhere. Finally, I found it in my jacket pocket! I usually don't forget things, but this week I'm really tired because I'm working long hours. Anyway, I'm landing in Madrid at six. Can you pick me up? There's a bus, but I don't want to take it. Call me back! Thanks.

4 Practice

What to do

1. Do the exercises in order. Do not look at the answers.
2. Write something in every box, even if you are not sure.
3. When you finish, go to the Answer Key at the end and correct your work.

A Choose the correct option.

1. My father _____ in a bank for thirty years. Now he's retired.
   a works | b worked | c was working
2. Water _____ at 100°C.
   a boils | b is boiling | c boiled
3. I _____ TV when the power went out.
   a watched | b was watching | c watch
4. Ten years ago there _____ a movie theater on this street.
   a is | b was | c were
5. We _____ to Spain last summer.
   a go | b went | c were going
6. Listen! Someone _____ at the door.
   a knocks | b knocked | c is knocking
7. _____ there any eggs in the fridge?
   a Is | b Are | c Does
8. At the moment I _____ a book about history.
   a read | b am reading | c was reading

B Complete the text with the correct form of the verbs in brackets.

1. Last weekend I _____ (visit) my grandparents.
2. They _____ (live) in a small village.
3. Their farm is big and there _____ (be) a lot of animals.
4. When we _____ (arrive), my grandfather was feeding the chickens.
5. My grandfather _____ (feed) the chickens when we arrived.
6. My grandmother always _____ (cook) delicious food on Sundays.
7. This time she _____ (make) a chocolate cake.
8. While we _____ (eat), it started to rain.
9. While we were eating, it _____ (start) to rain.
10. So we _____ (stay) inside and played cards.

C Find the mistake and write the correct sentence.

1. ~~I am knowing the answer.~~
   Write the correct sentence
2. ~~She go to work by bus every day.~~
   Write the correct sentence
3. ~~While I walked, I was seeing a fox.~~
   Write the correct sentence
4. ~~Did you went to school yesterday?~~
   Write the correct sentence
5. ~~There was three people in line.~~
   Write the correct sentence
6. ~~He doesn't working today.~~
   Write the correct sentence

D **Write a message of 100 to 120 words to your teacher about your vacation. Include: where you are (there is/are), what you usually do (present simple), what you did yesterday (past simple), what you were doing when something happened (past continuous) and what you are doing now (present continuous).**

1 Your message

E **Speaking: record a voice message of about 2 minutes on your phone telling a story from your last vacation. Listen to it and write down two mistakes you can correct.**

1 Two mistakes I found and how I corrected them

Finished? Tick the four boxes at the top of this block and check the Answer Key.

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key

Do not read this part until you finish the exercises of each block.

▼ Block 1 · To Be + There is / There are

Reading questions

1. In a small apartment in São Paulo.
2. No, there isn't.
3. There weren't any cafés and the streets were dirty.
4. The library, because it's old but beautiful and the librarians are kind.

Listening questions

1. Two.
2. No, there isn't.
3. A supermarket and three restaurants.
4. A party.
5. There weren't any windows in the kitchen.

Exercise A

1. b) is
2. b) are
3. a) Is
4. b) were
5. a) isn't
6. b) am

Exercise B

1. There is (also: There's)
2. were
3. There are
4. there weren't (also: there were not)
5. Is there
6. was

Exercise C

1. I am 20 years old. (also: I'm 20 years old. / I am 20. / I'm 20.)
2. There is a bakery near my house. (also: There's a bakery near my house.)
3. There are three chairs in the room.

4. Is there a cat in the yard?
5. Yes, I am.

Exercise D (model answers; yours can be different)

1. There is a small market near my house and there are two schools. There isn't a movie theater, but there is a big park.
2. I was at home. I was tired because I was at work all day.
3. There is a bed and a desk. There are two windows, a lot of books and some plants.
4. Ten years ago, there wasn't a metro station here, and there were fewer stores.

▼ **Block 2 · Present Simple + Past Simple**

Reading questions

1. At 6:30.
2. No, he doesn't.
3. He worked from home, woke up late, ate in front of the computer and felt tired.
4. He found a new job in a bigger company and moved near the office.

Listening questions

1. False. She usually wakes up late.
2. True.
3. False. She didn't take it.
4. Fish, at a small restaurant.
5. Her grandmother.

Exercise A

1. b) drinks
2. c) went
3. a) Do
4. a) see
5. b) lived
6. b) does

Exercise B

1. works
2. watched
3. doesn't like (also: does not like)
4. Did
5. bought
6. does
7. didn't see (also: did not see)

8. studies

Exercise C

1. He doesn't play soccer on Saturdays. (also: He does not play soccer on Saturdays.)
2. Does she live in Recife?
3. We didn't visit our grandparents. (also: We did not visit our grandparents.)
4. Did they go to the movies?
5. I ate breakfast at seven.

Exercise D (model answers; yours can be different)

1. I wake up at 6:30 and I take the bus to work. I usually have lunch at noon and I get home at 7.
2. On Saturday I went to a birthday party. On Sunday I stayed at home and watched a movie.
3. I started my first job in 2018. I didn't know anyone, but my colleagues were friendly.
4. I never eat meat. Last year I traveled by plane for the first time.

▼ Block 3 · Present Continuous + Past Continuous

Reading questions

1. Walking home from work.
2. A small cat.
3. Because it was cold.
4. His daughter.

Listening questions

1. At home.
2. Cooking dinner.
3. Watching TV in the living room.
4. A loud noise outside.
5. Running down the street.
6. Working from home.

Exercise A

1. b) is sleeping
2. a) know
3. b) was watching
4. a) rang
5. b) Are
6. b) were sleeping

Exercise B

1. is snowing

2. am walking (also: 'm walking)
3. were having
4. wasn't listening (also: was not listening)
5. were
6. is always losing (also: 's always losing)
7. was waiting
8. aren't working (also: are not working)

Exercise C

1. when
2. While
3. when
4. while
5. When

Exercise D (model answers; yours can be different)

1. I'm studying English right now. This week I'm working from home.
2. At 8 pm I was watching a series and eating dinner.
3. I was cooking when my neighbor knocked on the door.
4. My city is growing fast and a lot of new buildings are appearing.

▼ **Block 4 · Putting It All Together**

Reading questions

1. In a small café near the river in Lisbon.
2. They were taking photos.
3. No, he doesn't (but he enjoyed this one).
4. They're taking a train to Porto.

Listening questions

1. At the airport, in a café.
2. His flight is delayed.
3. He was packing his suitcase.
4. In his jacket pocket.
5. He's working long hours.
6. Pick him up at the airport.

Exercise A

1. b) worked
2. a) boils
3. b) was watching

4. b) was
5. b) went
6. c) is knocking
7. b) Are
8. b) am reading

Exercise B

1. visited
2. live
3. are
4. arrived
5. was feeding
6. cooks
7. made
8. were eating
9. started
10. stayed

Exercise C

1. I know the answer.
2. She goes to work by bus every day.
3. While I was walking, I saw a fox.
4. Did you go to school yesterday?
5. There were three people in line.
6. He isn't working today. (also: He is not working today.)

Exercise D (model answers; yours can be different)

1. Hi teacher! I'm at the beach and it's very sunny. There are a lot of people here. I usually wake up early, but on vacation I wake up late. Yesterday I went to a small town and I bought some gifts. I was walking to the bus stop when it started to rain, so I ran into a café. At the moment I'm drinking a coffee and I'm writing to you. See you soon!

Exercise E (model answers; yours can be different)

1. Example: I said 'I go to the beach yesterday'. Correct: 'I went to the beach yesterday.'

Audio: synthetic voices (Kokoro). Your answers are saved only in this browser.